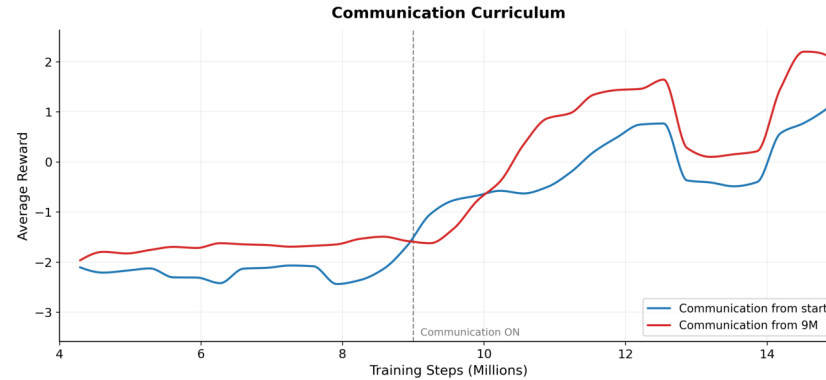
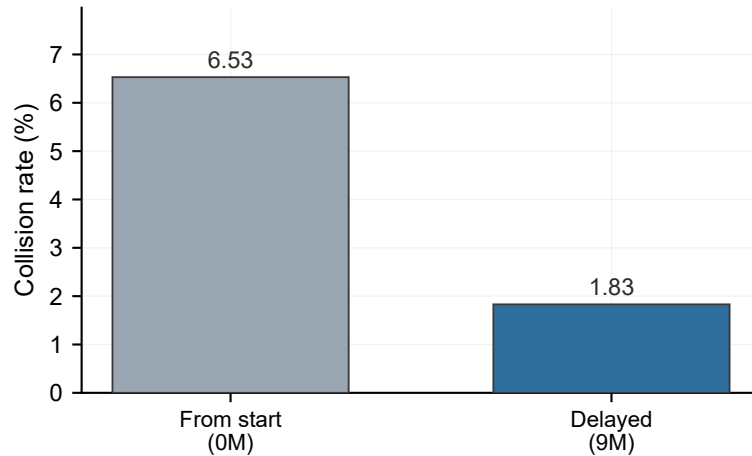


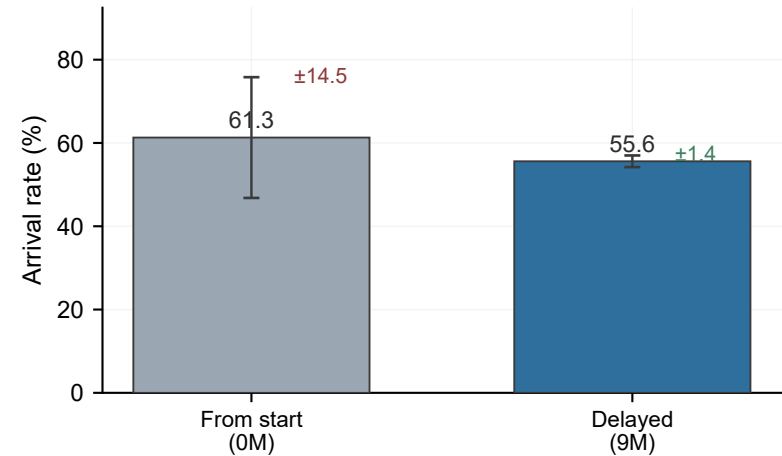
(a) Learning curves — communication switched on at 0M vs 9M



(b) Collision rate



(c) Arrival rate — mean $\pm$ seed spread



Overall COLREGs compliance 46.4% $\rightarrow$ 52.3% (delayed wins on all three seeds). Arrival mean favours from-start, but its seed spread is ten times larger — one seed converged to a rushing policy (timeout 15.6%, collisions $\times 3.7$). Establishing a stable local control policy before coupling agents through learned communication produces a safer, far less seed-sensitive solution.